

^b To ſerue me according to my worſhip. ^c That is, the abundance of Gods benedictions. ^d Your ſeed ſhall come to no proſperitie. ^e You boalt of your holines, ſacrifices and feaſts, but they ſhall turne to your ſhame, and be as vile as dung. ^f The Priests obiect a- gainſt the Prophet that he coulde not re- proue the, but he muſt ſpeake againſt the Priests bode, and the office eſta- bliſhed of God by promes, but he ſheweth, that the office is nothing ſclā- dered, when theſe vilenes, & dongue are called by their owne names. ^g He ſheweth what were the two condicions of the couenāt made with the tribe of Leui, on Gods parte, that he wolde giue the long life & felicitie, and on their parte, y they ſhulde faithfully ſerue him according to his worde. ^h I preſcribed Leui a certaine Law to ſerue me. ⁱ He ſerued me & ſet for- the my glorie with all humili- tie and ſub- miſſion. ^k He ſheweth that the Priests ought to haue knowledge to inſtrūct other in the worde of the Lord. ^l He is as the treaſure houſe of Gods worde, and ought to giue ſo cuerie one according to their neede, ſiſe, and not to reſerue it for him ſelf. ^m Shewing, that whoſoe- uer doeth not declare Gods wil, is not his meſſenger, and Priests.

1 If ye wil not heare it, nor conſider it in your heart to giue glorie ^b vnto my Name, ſaith y Lord of hoſtes, I wil euē ſend a curſe vpon you, and wil curſe your ^c bleſſings: yea, I haue curſed them already be- cauſe ye do not conſider it in your heart. Beholde, I wil corrupt ^d your ſeed, & caſt dōgue vpon your faces, ^e euen the ^e dongue of your ſolemne feaſts, and you ſhal be like vnto it.

4 And ye ſhal knowe, that I haue ^f ſent this commandement vnto you, that my couen- ant, which I made with Leui, might ſtād, ſaith the Lord of hoſtes.

5 My ^g couenat was with him of life and peace, and I ^h gaue him feare, & he feared me, and was aſtraide before ⁱ my Name.

6 The law of ^k trueth was in his mouth, & there was no iniquitie ſōūde in his lippes: he walked with me in peace and equitie, and did turne manie away from iniquitie.

7 For the Priests ^l lippes ſhulde preſerue knowledge, and they ſhulde ſeke the lawe at his mouth: for he is the ^m meſſenger of the Lord of hoſtes.

8 But ye are gone out of the way: ye haue cauſed manie to fall by the Law: ye haue brokē the couenāt of Leui, ſaith the Lord of hoſtes.

9 Therefore haue I alſo made you to be deſpiſed, and vile before all the people, be- cauſe ye kept not my wayes, but haue be- come parcial in the Law.

10 Haue we not all ⁿ one father? haue not one God made vs? why do we tranſgreſſe euerie one againſt his brother, and breake the couenat of ^o our fathers?

11 Iudāh haue tranſgreſſed, and an abomi- nation is committed in Iſraēl and in Ieru- ſalēm: for Iudāh haue deſiled the holines of the Lord, which he loued, and haue ma- ried the ^p daughter of a ſtrange god.

12 The Lord wil cut of the man that doeth this: ^q bothe the maſter and the ſeruāt out of the tabernacle of Iakōb, and him that offereth an offering vnto the Lord of hoſtes.

13 And this haue ye done againe, and ^r cou- ered the altar of y Lord with teares, with weping and with mourning: becauſe the offering is no more regarded, nether recei- ued acceptably at your hands.

14 Yet ye ſay, ^s Wherein? Becauſe the Lord haue bene witneſ betweene thee and thy wife of thy youth, againſt whome thou

ⁿ The Prophet accuſeth the ingratitude of the Iewes toward God and man: for ſeing they were all borne of one father A- braham, and God had elected them to be his holle people, they ought neither to offend God nor their brethren. ^o Whereby they had bounde them ſelues to God to be an holie people. ^p They haue ioyned them ſelues in marriage with them that are of another religion. ^q That is, the Priests. ^r Ye cauſe the people to lament, becauſe that God doeth not regarde their ſacrifices, ſo that they ſeme to ſacrifice in vaine. ^s This is another fault, wherof he accuſeth them, that is, that they breake the lawes of marriage.

haſt tranſgreſſed: yet is ſhe thy ^t cōpanion, and the wife of thy ^u couenat.

15 And did not ^x he make one? yet had he ^y abundance of ſpirit: and wherefore one? becauſe he ſought a godlie ^z ſeed: therefore kepe your ſelues in your ^a ſpirit, and let none treſpaſſe againſt the wife of his youth.

16 If thou hateſt her, ^b put her away, ſaith the Lord God of Iſraēl, yet he couereth ^c the iniurie vnder his garment, ſaith the Lord of hoſtes: therefore kepe your ſel- ues in your ſpirit, and tranſgreſſe not.

17 Ye haue wearied the ^d Lord with your wordes: yet ye ſay, Wherein haue we wearied him? Whē ye ſay, Euerie one ^e y doeth euil, is good in the ſight of the Lord, and he deliteth in them. Or where is the God of ^f iudgement?

boundes, and be ſober in minde, and bridle your affections. ^b Not that he doeth allowe diuorcement, but of the two faultes he ſheweth, which is the leſſe. ^c He thinketh it ſufficient to kepe his wife ſtil, albeit he take others, and ſo as it were couereth his fault. ^d Ye murmured againſt God, becauſe he heard not you aſſone as you called. ^e In thinking that God fauored the wicked, and haue no reſpect to them that ſerue him, ^f Thus they blaſphemed God in condemning his power and iuſtice, becauſe he iudged not according to their fantaſies.

CHAP. III.

1 Of the meſſenger of the Lord, Iohn Baptiſt, and of Chrſts office.

1 Beholde, I wil ſend my ^a meſſenger, & he ſhal prepare the way before me: & the ^b Lord whome ye ſeke, ſhal ſpedely come to his Temple: euen the ^c meſſenger of the couenat whome ye deſire: beholde, he ſhal come, ſaith the Lord of hoſtes.

2 But who ^d may abide the day of his com- ming? and who ſhal endure, when he ap- peareth? for he is like a purging fyre, and like fullers ſope.

3 And he ſhal ſit downe to trye and fine the ſiluer: he ſhal euen fine the ſonnes of ^e Le- ui, and purifie them as gold & ſiluer, that they may bring offerings vnto the Lord in righteouſnes.

4 Then ſhal the offerings of Iudāh and Ie- ruſalēm be acceptable vnto the Lord, as in olde time and in the yeres afore.

5 And I wil come nere to you to iudgemēt, and I wil be a ſwifte witneſ againſt the ſo- theſayers, and againſt the adulterers, and againſt falſe ſwearers, and againſt thoſe that wrongfully kepe backe the hirelings wages, and vex the widdowe, and the fa- therles, and oppreſſe the ſtranger, & feare not me, ſaith the Lord of hoſtes.

6 For I am the Lord: I change not, and ye ſonnes of Iakōb ^f are not conſumed.

7 From the daies of your fathers, ye are gone away from mine ordinances, and ha- ue not kept them: & returne vnto me, and I

therefore he accuſeth them of ingratitude, and ſheweth that in that they are not daily conſumed, it is a token, that he doeth ſtil defend them: and ſo his mercie toward them neuer changeth. ^g Read Zechar. 13.

Cccc.iii.

^t As the one halfe of thy felicitie. ^u She that was ioyned to thee by a ſolemne couenat, and by the inuoca- tion of Gods Name.

^x Did not God make man and woman as one fleſh and not many?

^y By his power & ver- tue he coulde haue made ma- ny women for one man.

^z Suche as ſhul- de be borne in lawful and mo- derat marriage wherein is no exceſſe of lu- ſtes.

^a Containe your ſelues within your

^b Not that

^c He thinketh it ſufficient to kepe his wife ſtil, albeit he take others, and ſo as it were couereth his fault.

^d Ye murmured againſt God, becauſe he heard not you aſſone as you called.

^e In thinking that God fauored the wicked, and haue no reſpect to them that ſerue him,

^f Thus they blaſphemed God in condemning his power and iuſtice, becauſe he iudged not according to their fantaſies.

^g Read Zechar. 13.

^h This is mēt

ⁱ of Iohn Bap- tiſt, as Chrſt expoundeth it, Luk. 7. 27.

^j Meaning, Meſſiah, as pſal. 140. 1.

^k dan. 9. 17.

^l That is, Chrſt by who- me the coue- nant was made and ratified, who is called the Angel or meſſenger of the couenat, becauſe he re- concileth vs to his father: & is Lord or King, becauſe he hath the gouernement of his Church.

^m He ſheweth that the hypo- crites which wiſh ſo much for the Lords coming, wil not abide whē he draweth ne- re: for he wil coſume them, and purge his & make them cleane.

ⁿ He begin- neth at y Pri- eſtes that they might be high- tes and ſhine vnto others.

^o They mur- mured againſt God, becauſe they ſawe not his helpe euer preſent to de- fend them: &

^p They mur- mured againſt God, becauſe they ſawe not his helpe euer preſent to de- fend them: &

^q They mur- mured againſt God, becauſe they ſawe not his helpe euer preſent to de- fend them: &

^r They mur- mured againſt God, becauſe they ſawe not his helpe euer preſent to de- fend them: &

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^l They mur- mured againſt God, becauſe they ſawe not his helpe euer preſent to de- fend them: &

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